

GLOSSARY

ABDUCTION

The criminal act of capturing and taking someone away against their will.

AGNOSTIC

Someone who neither believes or disbelieves in the existence of God.

ALIEN

A being from outer space.

AMBIVERT

A person whose character consists of a mix of introverted and extroverted qualities.

ANDROID

A robot with the form, characteristics, or behavior of a human.

ASTEROID

A small rocky body that orbits the sun.

ASTRONOMER

A person who studies the stars, planets, and other objects in space.

ATHEIST

Someone who does not believe in the existence of God.

BACTERIA

A group of single-celled microorganisms, some of which are harmless, but some can cause disease in people.

BIG BANG

The hugely explosive event that marked the beginning of the universe 13.7 billion years ago.

BINARY

A two-digit (0 and 1) number system used by computers to store data.

BRAINWASHING

The use of psychological games in an effort to instill certain ideas and beliefs in a person.

CAPITALISM

An economic system based on private ownership of the means of production, distribution, and exchange.

CLUSTER

A group of galaxies or stars held together by gravity.

COMMUNISM

A system of government in which the state controls the economy, and goods are equally shared by people.

CREATIONISM

The religious belief that all life, Earth, and the universe were created by a supernatural being.

DARK ENERGY

An energy form that makes up 73 per cent of the universe and that is responsible for the expansion of the universe.

DARK MATTER

Matter that does not emit energy but whose gravity affects its surroundings.

DEMOCRACY

A government elected by the people.

DINOSAUR

Any of the many now-extinct terrestrial reptiles from the Mesozoic era (about 250 million years ago to about 65 million years ago).

DNA

Deoxyribonucleic acid (DNA) is the hereditary material in humans and most other organisms.

ECOSYSTEM

A system formed by the interaction of a community of organisms within their environment.

ENDORPHIN

Any of several substances secreted in the brain that have a pain-relieving effect on the body.

EVOLUTION

A gradual process in which something changes into a different and often more complex or effective form.

FOSSIL

The remains of a plant or animal from a past geological age, embedded and preserved in Earth's crust.

GALAXY

A vast group of stars, gas, and dust held together by the forces of gravity.

GENE

A hereditary unit consisting of a sequence of DNA.

GENETICS

The branch of biology that studies heredity and variation between organisms.